CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Faxian says the people of the Gangetic plains were prosperous but also mentions chandalas outside the city. This shows 1

(a) equality
(b) no towns
(c) no trade
(d) prosperity and social inequality existed together

2. Which of these is a reason for the rise of new religions in this period? 1

(a) no trade **(b)** no change
(c) no cities **(d)** questioning of rituals and social change

3. What best explains why guild records survive on inscriptions? 1

(a) they had no money **(b)** they banned writing
(c) they were illegal **(d)** guilds made donations and were recorded

4. A historian uses both Hathigumpha and Puranic texts. This is called 1

(a) inventing **(b)** guesswork
(c) copying **(d)** cross-checking sources

5. If land grants were made to temples, the likely effect was 1

(a) spread of agriculture and rise of temple economy
(b) end of temples
(c) drop in trade
(d) end of farming

6. Which fact weakens the claim that early republics were fully democratic? 1

(a) women ruled
(b) no assembly
(c) all adults voted
(d) participation was limited to a certain group

7. Which of these best illustrates cultural exchange in Mauryan times? 1

(a) no contact **(b)** no trade
(c) no art **(d)** Greek and Indian art and ideas meeting

8. Which source would best tell us about the beliefs of ordinary people in this period? 1

(a) coins only **(b)** tax records of a modern state
(c) royal edicts only **(d)** donor inscriptions on stupas

9. What is the main difference between a prashasti and a traveller's account? 1

(a) one is modern
(b) one is by a court poet, the other by an outsider
(c) one is a map and the other a coin
(d) both are coins

10. Which clue best indicates a city's role as a trade centre? 1

(a) many coins and goods from distant places **(b)** large forests
(c) no walls **(d)** farm tools only

11. If the edicts are found from Kandahar to Karnataka, this shows 1

(a) the vast extent of Ashoka's empire **(b)** a trade fair
(c) his travel only **(d)** the weakness of Ashoka

12. A cave inscription records a king's victories and donations to monks. It is most likely from 1

(a) Sanchi **(b)** Madurai
(c) Kanchi **(d)** Udayagiri-Khandagiri

13. **Assertion (A):** The Iron Pillar of Delhi has not rusted for centuries. 1
Reason (R): A thin protective layer forms on the surface of the pillar.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** Vajji and Malla were republic mahajanapadas. 1
Reason (R): In republics, rule was by assemblies rather than a single king.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** Ashoka gave up war after the Kalinga war. 1
Reason (R): He felt remorse at the suffering caused by the war.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. What can the Sohgaura plate tell us? 2

17. Why is Sangam literature not purely historical? 2

18. Why did regional kingdoms rise at the end? 2

19. Why is the term 'urbanisation' used for this period? 2

20. Why did the Mauryas use polished stone? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Examine the role of religion in Gupta politics. 3

22. Analyse why Taxila and Pataliputra were important in different ways. 3

23. Examine how Ashoka's edicts reveal his personality. 3

24. Examine the importance of the Silk Route to Indian cities. 3

OR

Examine the evidence for social divisions in Gupta times. 3

25. Analyse why the republican system declined. 3

OR

Analyse why Ashoka's policy of dhamma was both moral and political. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** Around 321 BCE, Chandragupta Maurya, guided by his teacher Chanakya (Kautilya), overthrew the last Nanda king and took control of Magadha. He later built a large empire with Pataliputra as its capital. 5

(i) Who was the last Nanda king?
(ii) Who founded the Maurya Empire?
(iii) What was the capital of the Mauryas?
(iv) Why was Magadha a good base to build an empire?

27. Assess the argument that the post-Mauryan period was one of regional consolidation rather than decline. 5

OR

Assess the contribution of Gupta-era scientists to later knowledge. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND